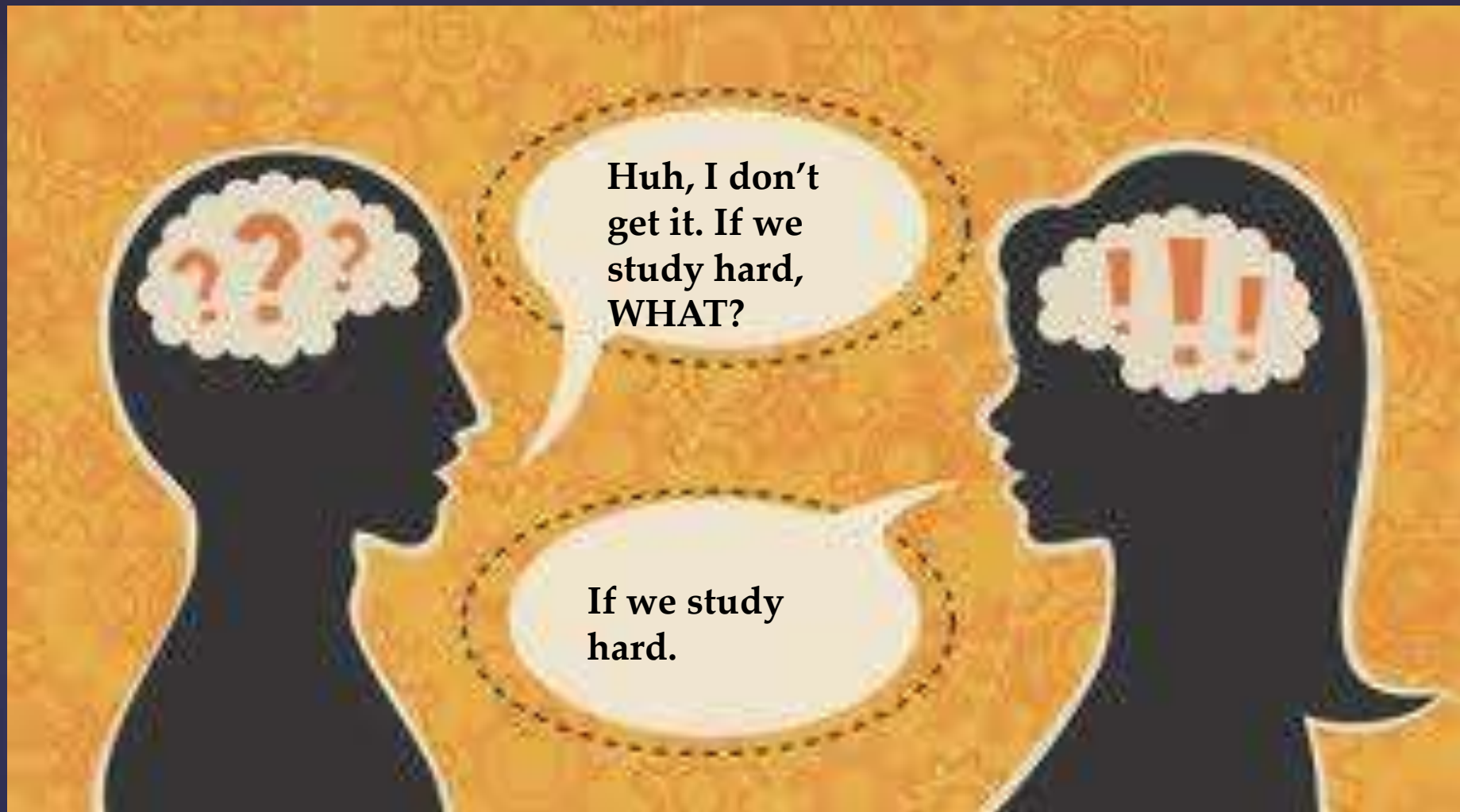


Sentence Problems-Fragments

- Sometimes a group of words looks like a sentence—it has a capital letter at the beginning and a period at the end—but it may be missing a subject or verb or both. These are called fragments.
- A dependent clause on its own is a fragment. It does not express a complete idea.
- Other times fragments are missing either a subject or a real verb.



When you have a fragment, it is like your reader is left hanging on a cliff. He/she isn't sure what you mean.





Let's fix them!



To fix a fragment that begins with a dependent clause, we must **add** an independent clause.

Fragments:

- **Since I started taking classes.**
- **Unless we study hard.**
- **If I don't understand.**

Fragments Fixed



1. Since I started taking classes, I have had to improve my time management skills.
2. We will not be successful in college unless we study hard.
3. If I don't understand, there are many resources available to me for extra explanations like my instructors and online tutoring.

Missing Verb Fragments

To change these fragments into sentences, we must make sure each has **a subject** and a **verb**.

1. Being late for class.
2. Left their books in the library.
3. Rasmussen a great place to get a degree.
4. To make it to graduation.

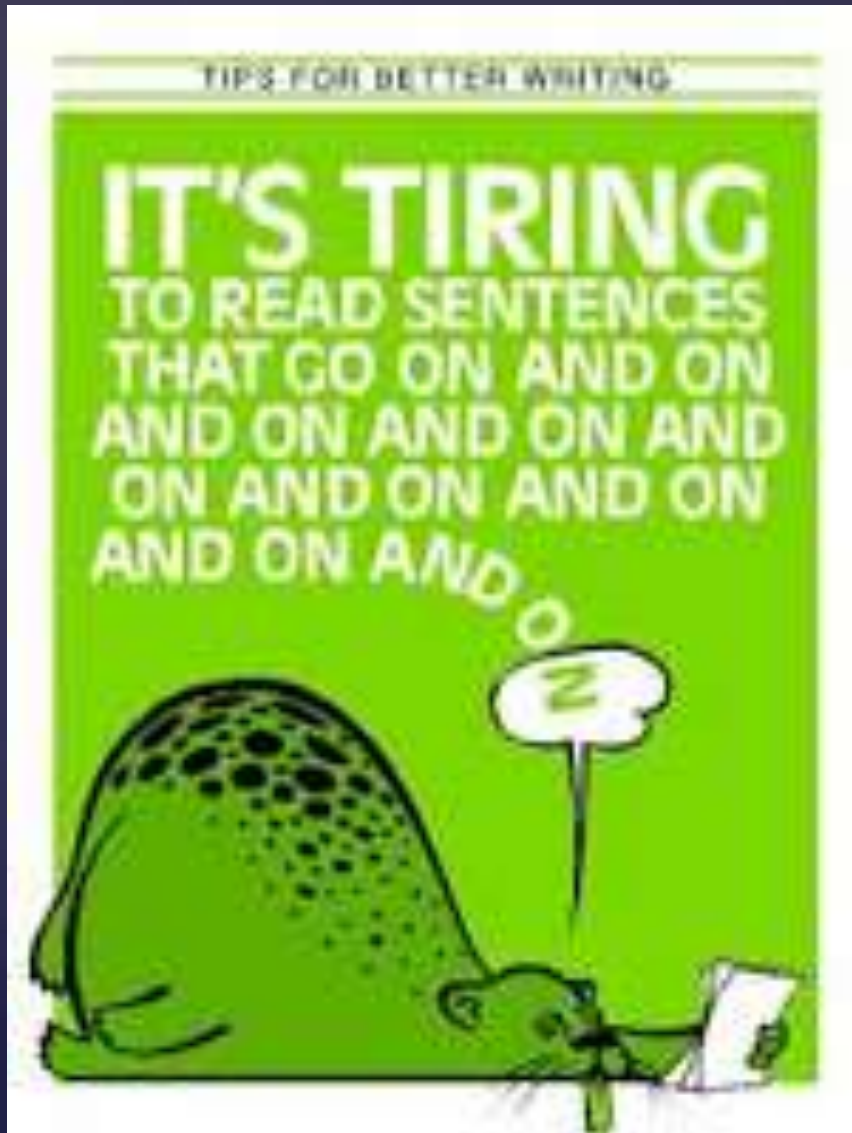


The Fixes

1. Being late for class makes a very negative impression.
2. Kim and Eric left their books in the library.
3. Rasmussen is a great place to get a degree.
4. My goal is to make it to graduation.



Run On Sentences

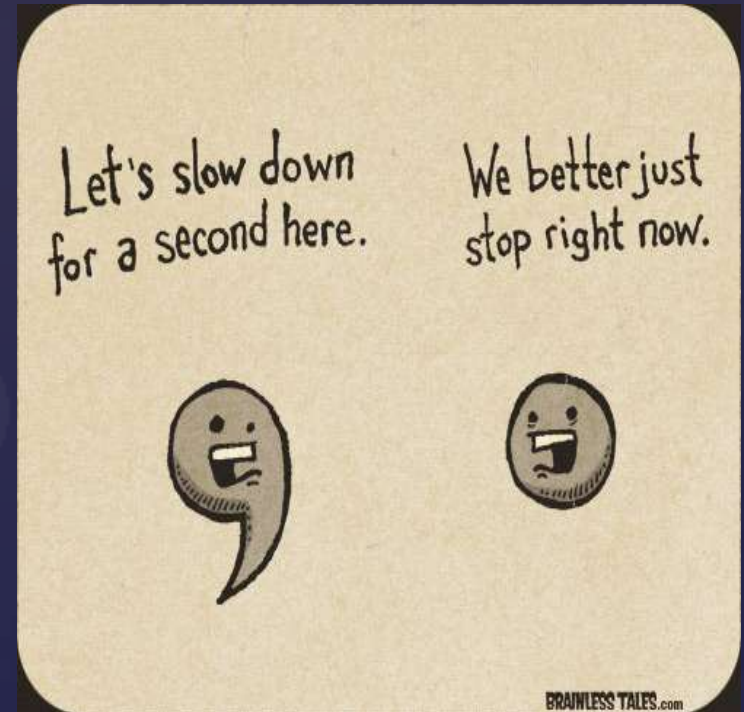


✓ rule to remember

A **run-on sentence** occurs when two independent clauses run together without proper punctuation or appropriate conjunctions.

Correcting Run-on Sentences

- Any word group with a subject and a verb is a clause.
- Remember an **independent clause** is one that is able to stand alone as a sentence.
- When **two independent clauses** are written together without proper punctuation between them, that is a run-on sentence.





Run-on Sentences

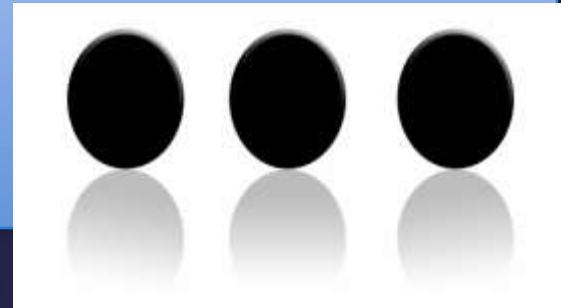
Where would you separate these **independent clauses**?

1. Exercise is a great way to relieve stress I try to work out every day.
2. I love to exercise first thing in the morning it gives me more energy for the rest of the day.

Correcting Run-on Sentences

Make the two independent clauses into two sentences by adding end punctuation.

- Exercise is a great way to relieve stress. I try to work out every day.
- I love to exercise first thing in the morning. It gives me more energy for the rest of the day.



Another Option

Connect the two independent clauses with a semicolon, but be careful when using a semicolon. The relationship between the two clauses must be obvious. The sentence is about ONE main idea.

Exercise is a great way to relieve stress; I try to work out every day.

I love to exercise first thing in the morning; it gives me more energy for the rest of the day.

;

Coordinating Conjunctions

<i>For</i>	<i>And</i>	<i>Nor</i>	<i>But</i>	<i>Or</i>	<i>Yet</i>	<i>So</i>
↓	↓	↓	↓	↓	↓	↓
<i>F</i>	<i>A</i>	<i>N</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>O</i>	<i>Y</i>	<i>S</i>

Third Option

Remember FANBOYS: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so.

Exercise is a great way to relieve stress, **SO** I try to work out every day.

I love to exercise first thing in the morning, **for** it gives me more energy for the rest of the day.

Remember to put your comma IN FRONT OF your conjunction.

Fourth Way to Correct Run-ons



Make one of the clauses dependent by adding a dependent marker word, such as *since*, *when*, *as*, *after*, *while*, or *because*.

Since exercise is a great way to relieve stress, I try to work out every day.

I love to exercise first thing in the morning because it gives me more energy for the rest of the day.

What is a sentence that has a subject and a verb, and has a punctuation mark at the end, but it does not have a complete thought?

- A. Rambling Sentence
- B. Run-On Sentence
- C. Sentence Fragment

a complete thought

The answer is sentence fragment.